

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 11

**MAHAJANAPADAS
PART-1**

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

SANGAM AGE

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

ORIGIN OF MAHAJANAPADAS

MAGADHAN DYNASTIES

FOREIGN INVASION

FACTS ABOUT MAHAJANAPADAS

ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENTS OF MAHAJANAPADAS

1

Region was **fertile** on account of better **rainfall and river systems**, which favored agriculture

2

Sedentary life style which made them to settle down.

3

More **returns** from land so people gained a strong **allegiance to the territory** they belonged to rather than the *Jana* or tribe.

BIRTH OF MAHAJANAPADAS

6

According to Buddhist texts, *Anguttara Nikaya* there were **16 independent states** (Mahajanapadas)

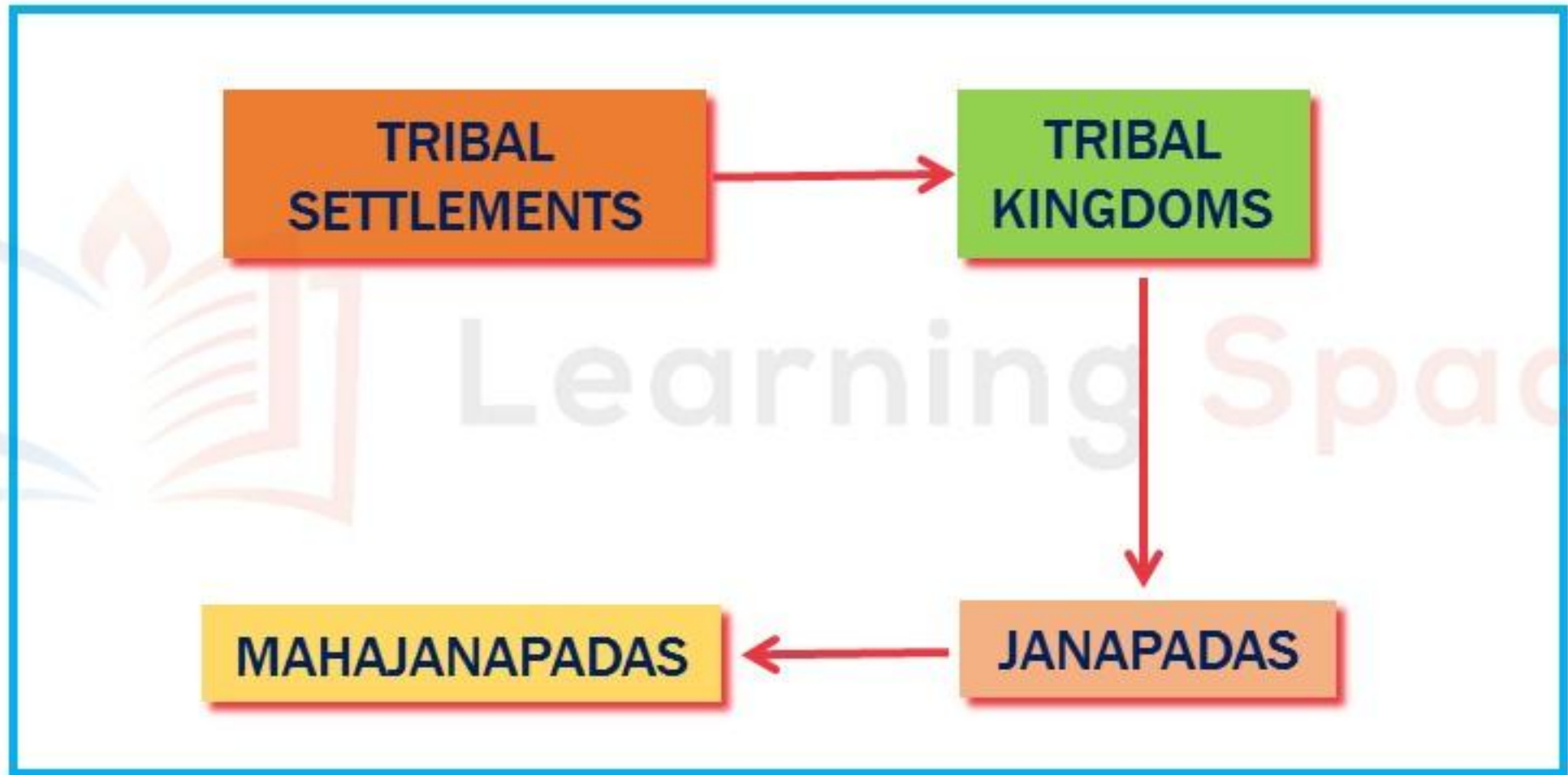
5

Some territorial states to become very large, and they came to be called **Mahajanapadas**

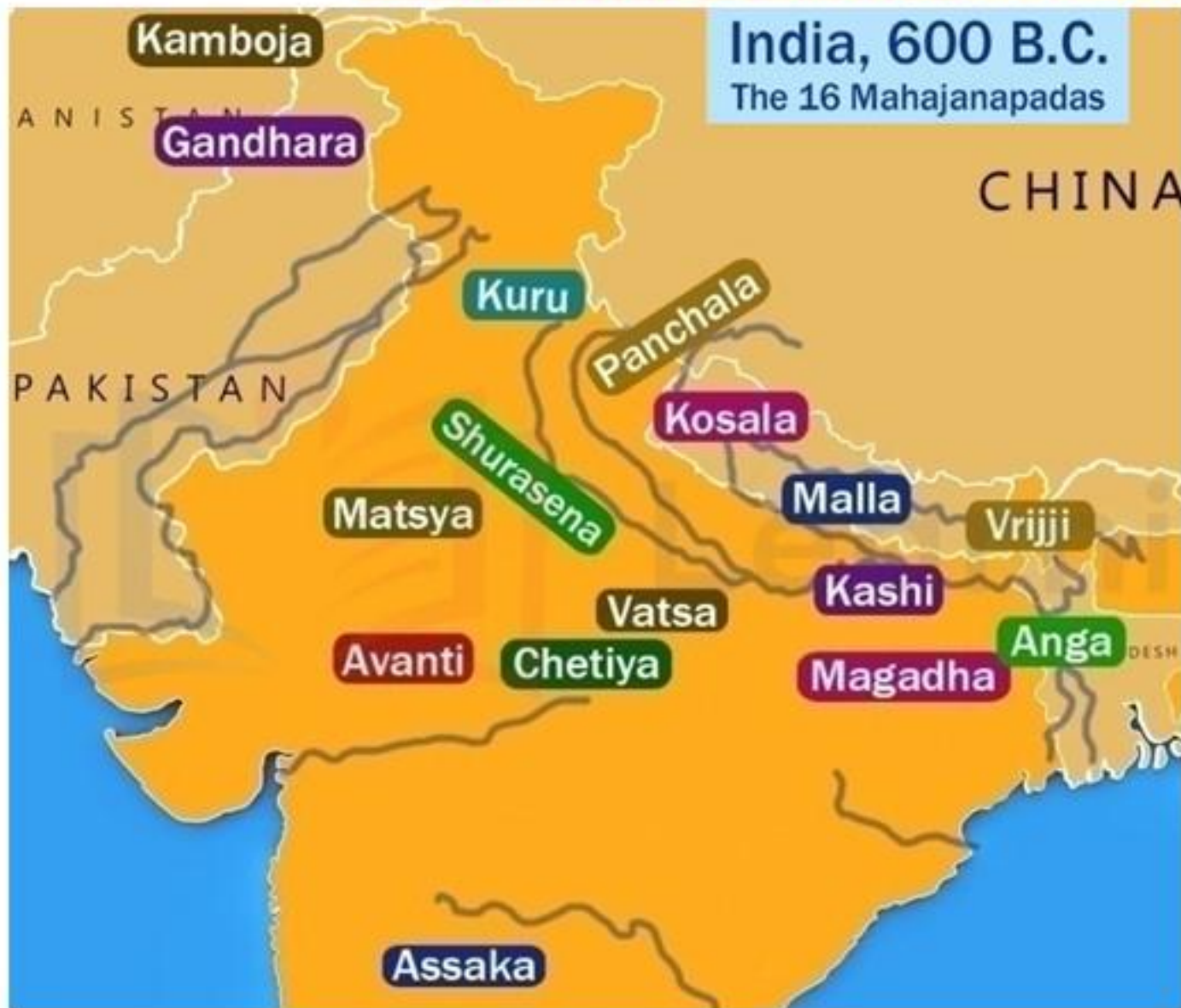
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Permanent settlements led to foundation of territorial states/janapadas.

ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENTS OF MAHAJANAPADAS



ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENTS OF MAHAJANAPADAS



1

Most of the Mahajanapadas were **fortified**

- Protect people and kingdom from attacks of other king
- Show how rich and powerful they were by building large, tall and impressive walls

2

The **political conflict** among the Mahajanapadas ultimately led to the **emergence of Magadha** as the most powerful state.

ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENTS OF MAHAJANAPADAS

6 First state to use **elephants** on a **large scale** which could be used

- storming fortresses
- marching over areas lacking roads.

5 Further, forests in southern areas provided it **timber and elephants**, which gave a special **military advantage**.

4 These fertile river plains provided a vast amount of **agricultural surplus**, which was essential for **raising** a vast **standing army**.

Reasons for rise of Magadha

1 Magadha enjoyed an **advantageous geographical position**

2 Due to its proximity and control over **richest iron deposits**, Magadhan -weapons were far superior and effective.

3 Lies in Gangetic plain, which had **fertile alluvium** and received heavy rainfall



ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENTS OF MAHAJANAPADAS**Reasons for
rise of
Magadha**

12 All these factors helped dynasties in Magadha region to expand their territory.

11 Because of the **rise of trade, towns, and metal money**, the tolls levied added to the treasury of Magadhan kings.

10 **Unorthodox character** of Magadhan society infused spirit for expansion than any other kingdoms.

7 Both of its capitals, **Rajgir(Rajgriha)** and **Patliputra**, were situated at strategic points.

8 **Girivraja or Rajagriha** was **surrounded by five hills**, which helped it to provide natural fortification.

9 **Pataliputra** was like a **water fort**, since it was situated at the confluence of the rivers Son and Ganga.





CHINA
(TIBET)

NEPAL

BHUTAN

BANGLADESH

Yamuna R
Ganga R

Kosi R

Son R

(PATNA) PATALIPUTRA

I N D I A

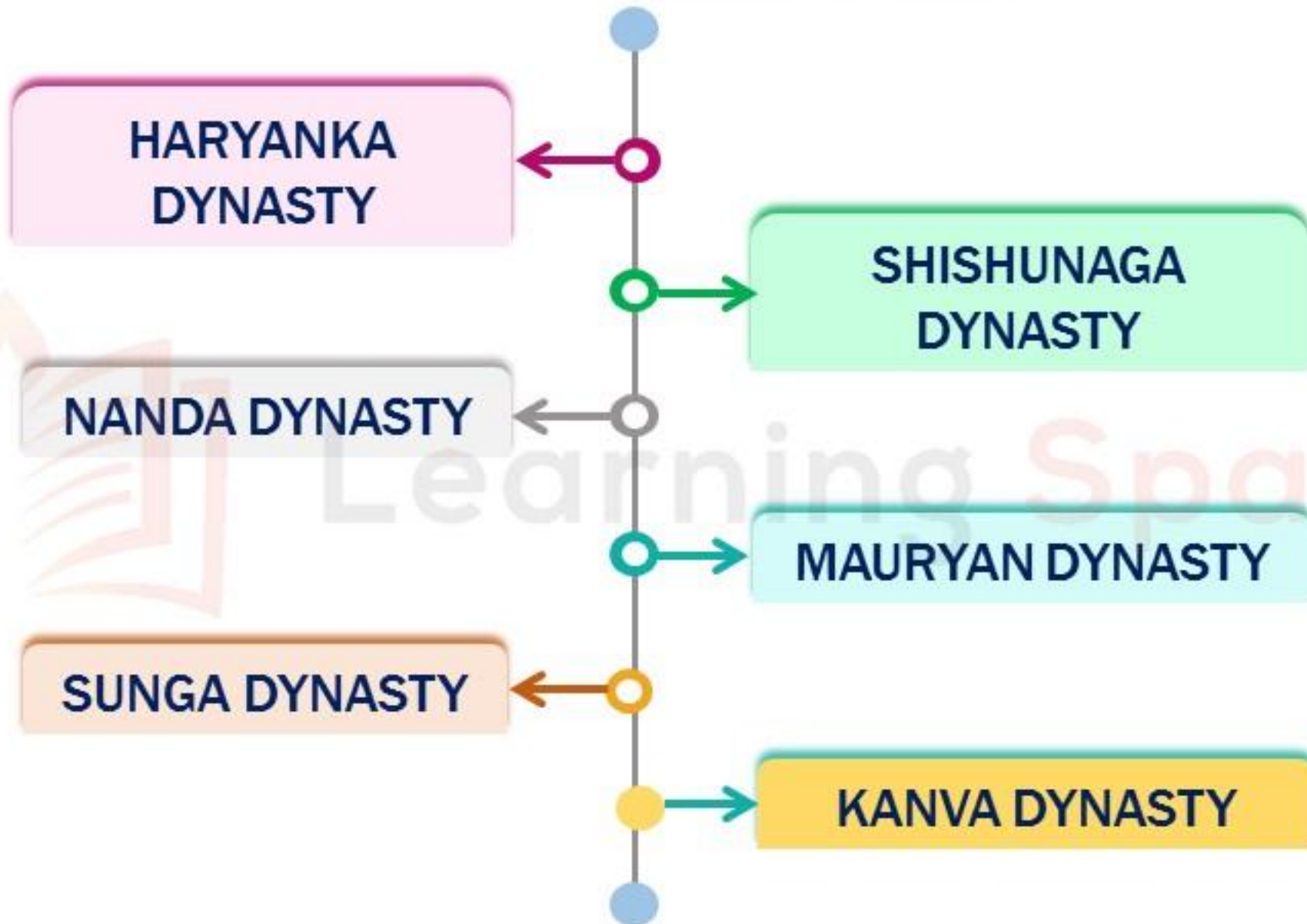
ORIGIN OF MAHAJANAPADAS

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MAGADHAN DYNASTIES



HARYANKA DYNASTY

(544 BC TO 413 BC)

GENEOLOGY



600 BC

BIMBISARA

(544 to 492 BC)

500 BC

AJATHASATRU

(492 to 460 BC)

400 BC

UDAYIN

(460 to 444 BC)

300 BC

HARYANKA DYNASTY

(544 BC TO 413 BC)

BIMBISARA

(544 to 492 BCE)

Three -
pronged
policy to
expand the
empire

Matrimonial
alliances

Friendship with
strong rulers

Conquest of
weak neighbours

1

He was the **founder** and ruled for 52 years.

2

Bimbisara made Magadha the paramount power with **capital Rajgriha** (Girivraja) surrounded by five hills.

3

Contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira

SOME FACTS TO REMEMBER: Bimbisara's royal physician was **Jivaka**.

HARYANKA DYNASTY

(544 BC TO 413 BC)

AJATASHATRU

(492 BCE – 460 BCE)

Two innovative
military weapons

War engine, which
was used to throw
stones like catapults
(*Mahashilakantaka*)

Chariot with
mace for
mass-killing
(*Rathamusala*)

1

Son of Bimbisara, is believed to have **killed his father** (Patricide) and seized the throne.

2

- Most powerful and aggressive ruler of the dynasty.
- Followed his father's expansionist policy through military conquest.

3

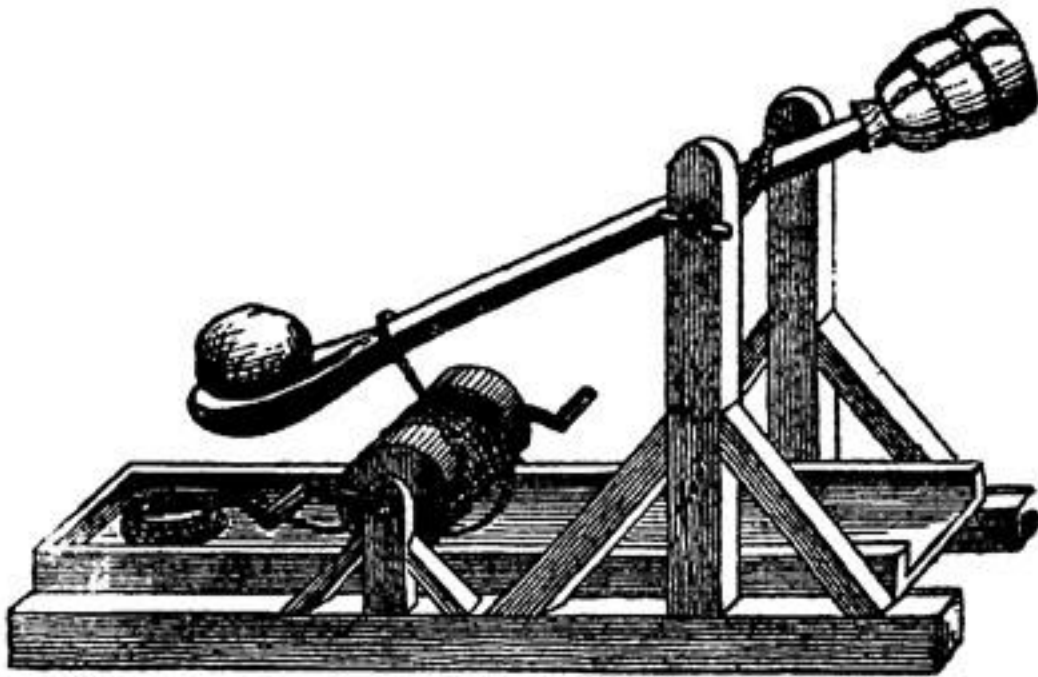
- The **Buddha** died during his reign.
- Arranged the **first Buddhist council**.

HARYANKA DYNASTY

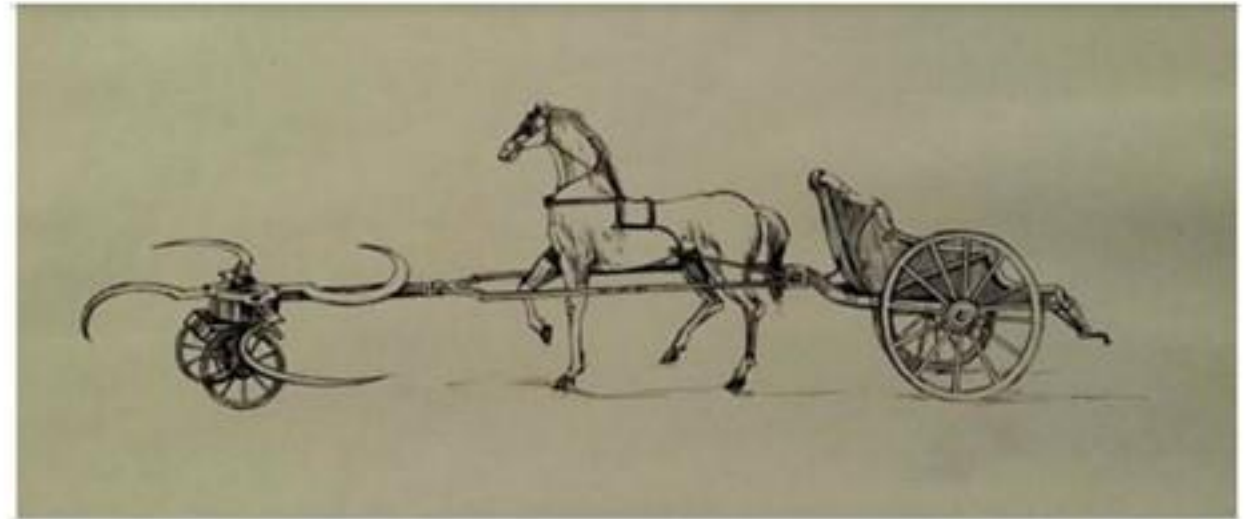
(544 BC TO 413 BC)

AJATASHATRU

(492 BCE – 460 BCE)



MAHASHILAKANTAKA



RATHAMUSALA

HARYANKA DYNASTY

(544 BC TO 413 BC)

UDAYABHADRA(UDAYIN)

(460 BCE – 444 BCE)

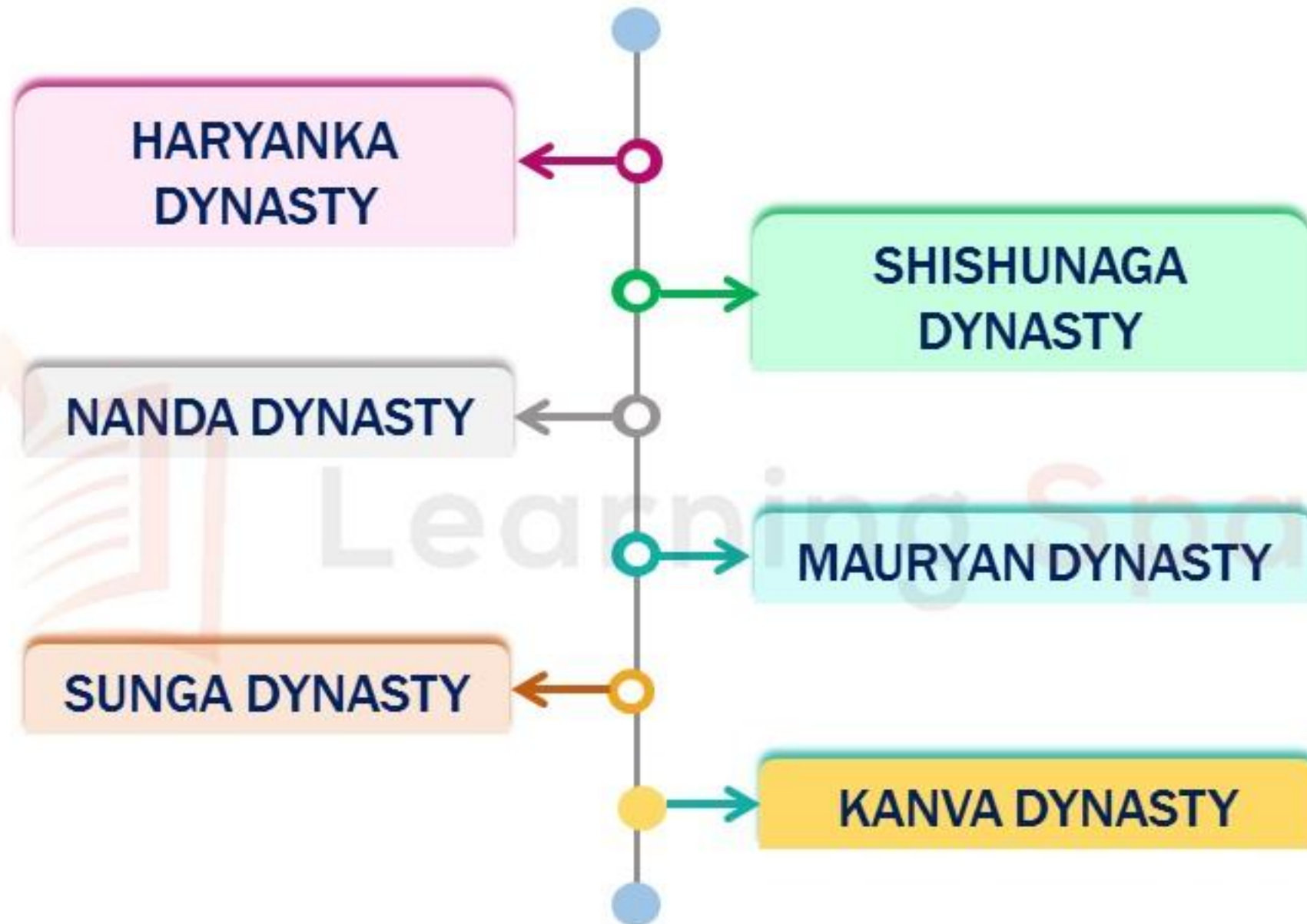


1

Founded the new capital at Pataliputra (modern Patna), situated at the confluence of Ganga and Son rivers.

2

It is believed that the people of Magadha, outraged by the successive patricides of the successors of Udayin, appointed Shishunaga who was Amatya (high ranking official) as king.



SHISHUNAGA DYNASTY

(413 BCE – 345 BCE)

GENEOLOGY



500 BC

400 BC

300 BC

200 BC

SHISHUNAGA

KALASOKA

SHISHUNAGA DYNASTY

(413 BCE – 345 BCE)

SHISHUNAGA

Son and
successor

KALASOKA

1 Temporarily shifted capital to Vaishali.

2 Greatest achievement was to defeat Avanti (Pradyota Dynasty) and make it a part of Magadha.

1 Second Buddhist Council held at Vaishali.

2 Also known as Kakarvarna (according to the Puranas).



CHINA

PAKISTAN

Shravasti

Vaishali

Kaushambi

Pataliputra

Varanasi

Rajagriha

Champa

BHUTAN

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

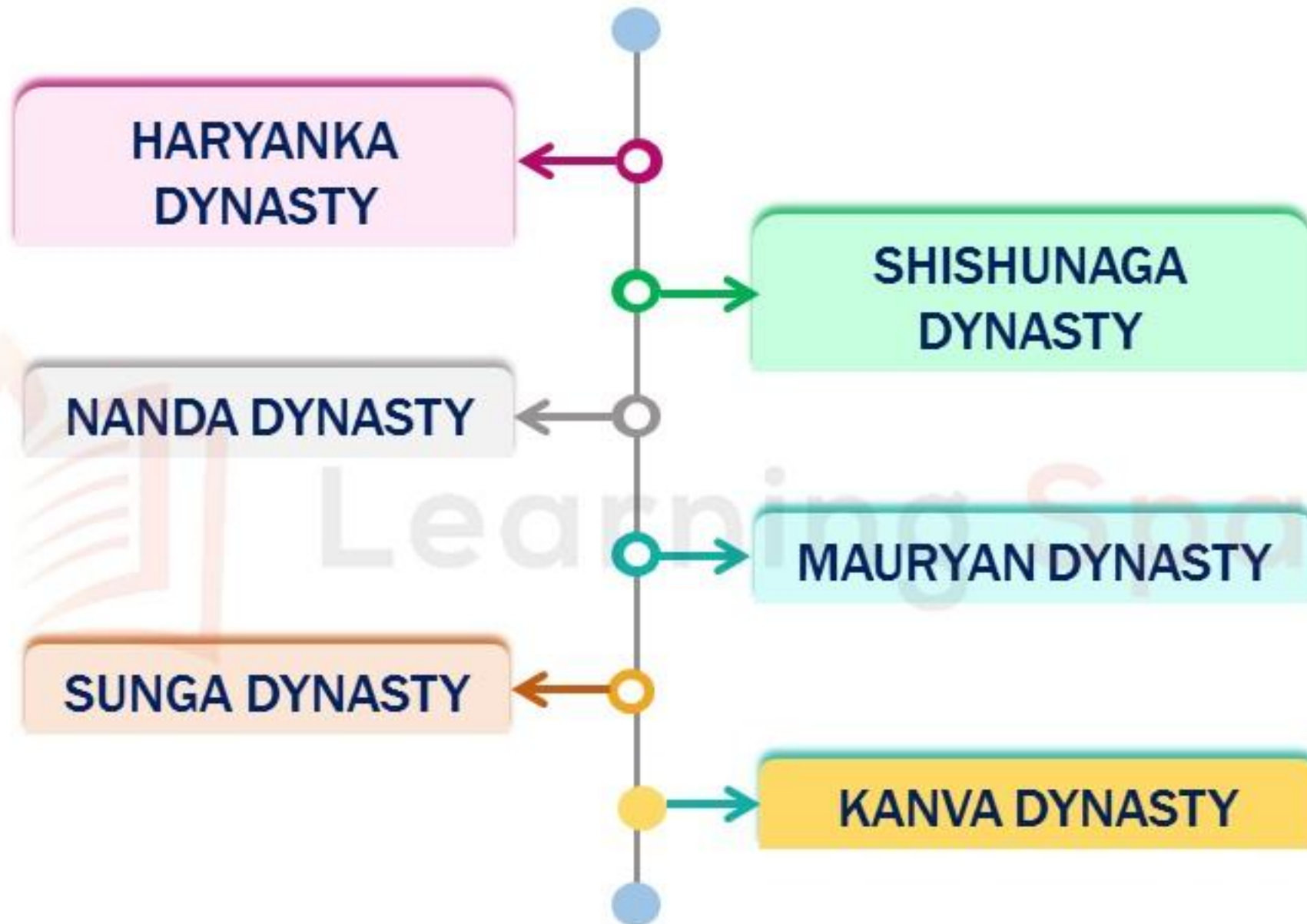
INDIA

Ujjain

Vidisha

-  Haryanka Dynasty (5th Century BCE)
-  Shishunaga Dynasty (Early 4th Century BCE)

Bay of Bengal



NANDA DYNASTY

(345 BCE – 321 BCE)

GENEOLOGY



500 BC

400 BC

300 BC

200 BC

MAHAPADMANANDA

DHANANANDA

NANDA DYNASTY

(345 BCE – 321 BCE)

MAHAPADMA NANDA



(FIRST NON-KSHATRIYA DYNASTY)

- 1 According to the Brahmanical texts, he belonged to a low caste or at least a **non-Kshatriya caste**.
- 2 The first empire builder of India, and claimed to be the **ekarat**, the sole sovereign who destroyed all other ruling princes.
- 3 Also called **Ugrasena** in Pali texts, because of his large army.

NANDA DYNASTY

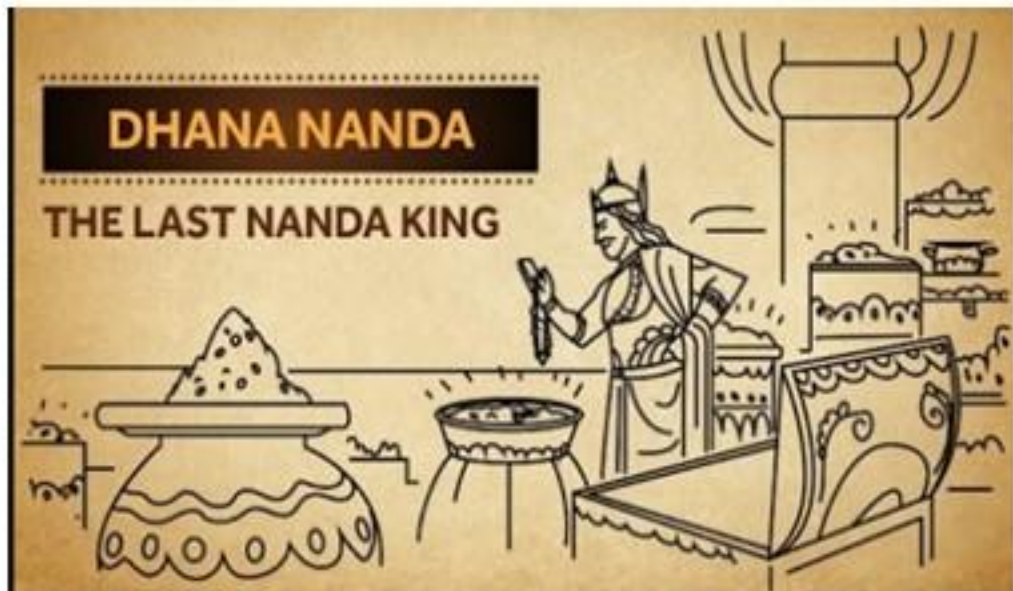
(345 BCE – 321 BCE)

DHANANANDA

- 1 It is believed that **Alexander attacked** Punjab during his reign but his huge army **checked them** from advancing towards Magadha.

- 2 He is believed to be an **arrogant and oppressive ruler** who imposed **heavy taxes** on the common man. His greed and **exploitation** made him **quite unpopular** among the masses.

- 3 **Chandragupta Maurya** under the able guidance of Kautilya, **took the advantage of this public resentment** and uprooted the Nanda rule and set up the Maurya empire.



THOUGHT PROVOKING QUESTIONS

Q.1

The 6th Century BCE saw the rise of big territorial states called the Mahajanapads. What were the reasons facilitating the rise of such big states? Which were the major Mahajanpadas and which emerged the most powerful amongst them? Explain giving suitable examples.

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